

Motivational Letter

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am fascinated by the global economy and the international financial markets because they are constantly shaped by the interplay of numerous players and by economic and business factors, such as individual corporate decisions and capital allocation. It is precisely these interactions that interest me most, as no two market situations are alike and new information continually influences the market. I am particularly impressed by the capital markets, as they channel capital to where it can most effectively promote long-term growth and innovation. The interplay between global developments and analytical decision-making processes motivates me to develop a deeper understanding of market processes, such as investment processes.

My career to date has been characterised by a drive to continually measure myself against the best, thereby constantly developing my skills and, through initiative and discipline, achieving above-average performance. This was already evident in competitive football, where I was voted the best player out of around 140 participants at a Real Madrid summer camp, thereby qualifying for the national Real Madrid try-outs. I apply this same standard of excellence in my academic life as well. For instance, I was awarded a scholarship from e-fellows.net, received recognition for my exceptional commitment to the Democracy Club, and came second in the 2022 Baden-Württemberg State Parliament competition. Through these projects, I was able to further develop my communication skills, team spirit and sense of personal responsibility, particularly through the planning and organisation of school events such as the 'Night of Democracy'. My keen interest in finance led me, even before I began my degree, to undertake an internship in auditing at Baker Tilly, where I gained initial insights into annual accounts and balance sheet analysis, as well as into the workings of an internationally active professional services firm. I will be taking the next step in my academic development at the University of St Gallen, having completed its rigorous admissions process with a result that outperformed 89.4 per cent of all applicants. This test enabled me to demonstrate my logical thinking and quantitative problem-solving skills, particularly under significant time pressure and the need to perform. My qualities, in particular my analytical mindset, resilience and performance-oriented approach, have had a lasting impact on me and reinforced my ability to add value, even in a demanding and performance-oriented environment such as BlackRock's Spring Week.

"The day you think you know everything is the day you start to lose. You have to always be a student." (Larry Fink). In my view, this quote reflects an attitude that I also associate with BlackRock. His words have stayed with me deeply over the past few months and have motivated me always to be open to new ideas and to maintain a constant willingness to learn. BlackRock combines asset management with technological innovation. Its proprietary technology platform, "Aladdin", for example, carries out risk analyses and simulates stress tests to visualise how portfolios might behave in specific crises such as pandemic outbreaks or wars. This combination of finance and technology, along with the increasing use of artificial intelligence, makes BlackRock particularly interesting to me and reinforces my desire to learn more about it. I would also like to find out what impact artificial intelligence and its further developments are having on the working environment at BlackRock, and how technological innovations and advancements can support and transform investment decisions.

I am convinced that I meet the professional and personal requirements for BlackRock's Spring Week programme. My keen interest in capital markets, as well as my sporting achievements (qualifying for Real Madrid's national trials) and academic achievements (being awarded the e-fellows scholarship), underpin my motivation. I would like to take this opportunity to deepen my understanding of economic interrelationships and decision-making processes. I would also like to demonstrate and further develop my resilience and discipline, as well as my analytical thinking and ability to work in a team, through joint case studies.

Yours sincerely,
Jacob Keintzel